

Bhagavad Gita - Chapter 4

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

043. Chapter 4 Verses 1-3

VERSE 4.1

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
इमं विवस्वते योगं प्रोक्तवानहमव्ययम् ।
विवस्वान्मनवे प्राह मनुरिक्ष्वाकवेऽब्रवीत् ॥१॥

śhrī bhagavān uvācha
imam vivasvate yogam proktavān aham avyayam
vivasvān manave prāha manur ikṣhvākave 'bravīt

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha—the Supreme Lord Shree Krishna said; **imam**—this; **vivasvate**—to the Sun God; **yogam**—the science of Yog; **proktavān**—taught; **aham**—I; **avyayam**—eternal; **vivasvān**—Sun God; **manave**—to Manu, the original progenitor of humankind; **prāha**—told; **manuḥ**—Manu; **ikṣhvākave**—to Ikshvaku, first king of the Solar dynasty; **abravīt**—instructed

The Blessed Lord said: This imperishable Yoga of action (and the wisdom arising from it) I taught to Vivasvan (the Sun) at the beginning of creation. Vivasvan taught it to his son Manu, and Manu to his son Ikshvaku.

VERSE 4.2

एवं परम्पराप्राप्तमिमं राजर्षयो विदुः ।
स कालेनेह महता योगो नष्टः परन्तप ॥ २ ॥

evaṁ paramparā-prāptam imaṁ rājarṣhayo viduḥ
sa kāleneha mahatā yogo naṣṭaḥ parantapa

evam—thus; **paramparā**—in a continuous tradition; **prāptam**—received; **imam**—this (science); **rāja-ṛiṣhayaḥ**—the saintly kings; **viduḥ**—understood; **saḥ**—that; **kālena**—with the long passage of time; **iha**—in this world; **mahatā**—great; **yogaḥ**—the science of Yog; **naṣṭaḥ**—lost; **parantapa**—Arjun, the scorcher of foes

O Arjuna! The royal sages know this (yoga) which was handed down in regular succession from generation to generation. But by long lapse of time, this Yoga was lost to the world.

VERSE 4.3

स एवायं मया तेऽद्य योगः प्रोक्तः पुरातनः ।
भक्तोऽसि मे सखा चेति रहस्यं ह्येतदुत्तमम् ॥३॥

sa evāyaṁ mayā te 'dya yogaḥ proktaḥ purātaṇaḥ
bhakto 'si me sakhā cheti rahasyaṁ hyetad uttamam

saḥ—that; **eva**—certainly; **ayam**—this; **mayā**—by me; **te**—unto you; **adya**—today; **yogaḥ**—the science of Yog; **proktaḥ**—reveal; **purātaṇaḥ**—ancient; **bhaktaḥ**—devotee; **asi**—you are; **me**—my; **sakhā**—friend; **cha**—and; **iti**—therefore; **rahasyam**—secret; **hi**—certainly; **etat**—this; **uttamam**—supreme

This same ancient Yoga has now been taught by Me, for you are My devotee and friend. It is indeed the supreme secret.

044. Chapter 4 Verses 4-6

VERSE 4.4

अर्जुन उवाच ।

अपरं भवतो जन्म परं जन्म विवस्वतः ।

कथमेतद्विजानीयां त्वमादौ प्रोक्तवानिति ॥४॥

arjuna uvācha

aparam bhavato janma param janma vivasvataḥ

katham etad vijānīyām tvam ādau proktavān iti

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun said; **aparam**—later; **bhavataḥ**—your; **janma**—birth; **param**—prior; **janma**—birth; **vivasvataḥ**—Vivasvan, the Sun God; **katham**—how; **etat**—this; **vijānīyām**—am I to understand; **tvam**—you; **ādau**—in the beginning; **proktavān**—taught; **iti**—thus

Arjuna said: Later was your birth, earlier the birth of Vivasvan (Sun); how then am I to understand that you taught it to him in the beginning?

VERSE 4.5

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

बहूनि मे व्यतीतानि जन्मानि तव चार्जुन ।

तान्यहं वेद सर्वाणि न त्वं वेत्थ परन्तप ॥ 5 ॥*

śhrī bhagavān uvācha

bahūni me vyatītāni janmāni tava chārjuna

tānyaham veda sarvāṇi na tvam vettha parantapa

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha—the Supreme Lord said; **bahūni**—many; **me**—of mine; **vyatītāni**—have passed; **janmāni**—births; **tava**—of yours; **cha**—and; **arjuna**—Arjun; **tāni**—them; **aham**—I; **veda**—know; **sarvāṇi**—all; **na**—not; **tvam**—you; **vettha**—know; **parantapa**—Arjun, the scorcher of foes

The Lord said: O Arjuna! Many births of Mine have passed as well as yours. I know them all but you know them not.

VERSE 4.6

अजोऽपि सन्नव्ययात्मा भूतानामीश्वरोऽपि सन् ।
प्रकृतिं स्वामधिष्ठाय सम्भवाम्यात्ममायया ॥६॥

ajo 'pi sannavyayātmā bhūtānām īśhvaro 'pi san
prakṛitiṁ svām adhiṣṭhāya sambhavāmyātmā-māyayā

ajaḥ—unborn; **api**—although; **san**—being so; **avyaya ātmā**—Imperishable nature; **bhūtānām**—of (all) beings; **īśhvaraḥ**—the Lord; **api**—although; **san**—being; **prakṛitim**—nature; **svām**—of myself; **adhiṣṭhāya**—situated; **sambhavāmi**—I manifest; **ātmā-māyayā**—by my Yogmaya power

**Though unborn and eternal in My being, the Lord and
controller of all beings, controlling My own nature, I come
into being by the power of My Maya-Sakti.**

045. Chapter 4 Verses 7-8

VERSE 4.7

यदा यदा हि धर्मस्य ग्लानिर्भवति भारत ।
अभ्युत्थानमधर्मस्य तदात्मानं सृजाम्यहम् ॥७॥

yadā yadā hi dharmasya glānir bhavati bhārata
abhyutthānam adharmasya tadātmānaṁ sṛjāmyaham

yadā yadā—whenever; hi—certainly; dharmasya—of righteousness; glāniḥ—decline; bhavati—is; bhārata—Arjun, descendant of Bharat; abhyutthānam—increase; adharmasya—of unrighteousness; tadā—at that time; ātmānam—self; sṛjāmi—manifest; aham—I

O Arjuna! Whenever there is a decline of righteousness and rise of evil, I manifest Myself.

VERSE 4.8

परित्राणाय साधूनां विनाशाय च दुष्कृताम् ।
धर्मसंस्थापनार्थाय सम्भवामि युगे युगे ॥८॥

paritrāṇāya sādḥūnām vināśhāya cha duṣhkṛitām
dharma-sanstḥāpanārthāya sambhavāmi yuge yuge

paritrāṇāya—to protect; **sādḥūnām**—the righteous; **vināśhāya**—to annihilate;
cha—and; **duṣhkṛitām**—the wicked; **dharma**—the eternal religion;
sansthāpana-arthāya—to reestablish; **sambhavāmi**—I appear; **yuge yuge**—age
after age

**For the protection of the good, for the destruction of the
wicked, and for establishing Dharma, I take birth in every
age.**

046. Chapter 4 Verses 9-10

VERSE 4.9

जन्म कर्म च मे दिव्यमेवं यो वेत्ति तत्त्वतः ।
त्यक्त्वा देहं पुनर्जन्म नैति मामेति सोऽर्जुन ॥९॥

janma karma cha me divyam evaṁ yo vetti tattvataḥ
tyaktvā dehaṁ punar janma naiti mām eti so 'rjuna

janma—birth; **karma**—activities; **cha**—and; **me**—of mine; **divyam**—divine;
evam—thus; **yaḥ**—who; **vetti**—know; **tattvataḥ**—in truth; **tyaktvā**—having
abandoned; **deham**—the body; **punaḥ**—again; **janma**—birth; **na**—never; **eti**—
takes; **mām**—to me; **eti**—comes; **sah**—he; **arjuna**—Arjun

Those who understand the divine nature of My birth and activities, O Arjun, upon leaving the body, do not have to take birth again, but come to My eternal abode.

VERSE 4.10

वीतरागभयक्रोधा मन्मया मामुपाश्रिताः ।
बहवो ज्ञानतपसा पूता मद्भावमागताः ॥ 10 ॥

vīta-rāga-bhaya-krodhā man-mayā mām upāśhritāḥ
bahavo jñāna-tapasā pūtā mad-bhāvam āgatāḥ

vīta—free from; **rāga**—attachment; **bhaya**—fear; **krodhāḥ**—anger; **mat-mayā**—completely absorbed in me; **mām**—in me; **upāśhritāḥ**—taking refuge (of); **bahavaḥ**—many (persons); **jñāna**—of knowledge; **tapasā**—by the fire of knowledge; **pūtāḥ**—purified; **mat-bhāvam**—my divine love; **āgatāḥ**—attained

Free from desire, fear, and hatred, absorbed in Me, taking refuge in Me, many purified by the penance of knowledge have attained Me.

047. Chapter 4 Verses 11-13

VERSE 4.11

ये यथा मां प्रपद्यन्ते तांस्तथैव भजाम्यहम् ।
मम वर्त्मानुवर्तन्ते मनुष्याः पार्थ सर्वशः ॥ 11 ॥

ye yathā mām prapadyante tāns tathaiva bhajāmyaham
mama vartmānuvartante manuṣhyāḥ pārtha sarvaśhaḥ

ye—who; yathā—in whatever way; mām—unto me; prapadyante—surrender;
tān—them; tathā—so; eva—certainly; bhajāmi—reciprocate; aham—I; mama—
my; vartma—path; anuvartante—follow; manuṣhyāḥ—men; pārtha—Arjun,
the son of Pritha; sarvaśhaḥ—in all respects

O Arjuna! In whatsoever form one seeks Me, I reach him in that form, for all mankind are but following the paths I laid down for them.

VERSE 4.12

काङ्क्षन्तः कर्मणां सिद्धिं यजन्त इह देवताः ।
क्षिप्रं हि मानुषे लोके सिद्धिर्भवति कर्मजा ॥ 12 ॥

kāṅkṣhantaḥ karmaṇām siddhiṁ yajanta iha devatāḥ
kṣhipram hi mānuṣhe loke siddhir bhavati karmajā

kāṅkṣhantaḥ—desiring; **karmaṇām**—material activities; **siddhiṁ**—success; **yajante**—worship; **iha**—in this world; **devatāḥ**—the celestial gods; **kṣhipram**—quickly; **hi**—certainly; **mānuṣhe**—in human society; **loke**—within this world; **siddhiḥ**—rewarding; **bhavati**—manifest; **karma-jā**—from material activities

Longing for success in action, in this world, (men) worship the deities. For success is quickly attained through action in this world of Man.

VERSE 4.13

चातुर्वर्ण्यं मया सृष्टं गुणकर्मविभागशः ।
तस्य कर्तारमपि मां विद्ध्यकर्तारमव्ययम् ॥ 13 ॥

chātur-varṇyam mayā sṛiṣṭam guṇa-karma-vibhāgaśhaḥ
tasya kartāram api mām viddhyakartāram avyayam

chātuḥ-varṇyam—the four categories of occupations; **mayā**—by me; **sṛiṣṭam**—were created; **guṇa**—of quality; **karma**—and activities; **vibhāgaśhaḥ**—according to divisions; **tasya**—of that; **kartāram**—the creator; **api**—although; **mām**—me; **viddhi**—know; **akartāram**—non-doer; **avyayam**—unchangeable

The four castes were created by Me according to the division of gunas and karma. Though I am their Creator, yet know that I neither act nor change.

048. Chapter 4 Verses 14-17

VERSE 4.14

न मां कर्माणि लिम्पन्ति न मे कर्मफले स्पृहा ।
इति मां योऽभिजानाति कर्मभिर्न स बध्यते ॥ 14 ॥

na mām karmāṇi limpanti na me karma-phale spṛihā
iti mām yo 'bhijānāti karmabhir na sa badhyate

na—not; **mām**—me; **karmāṇi**—activities; **limpanti**—taint; **na**—nor; **me**—my; **karma-phale**—the fruits of action; **spṛihā**—desire; **iti**—thus; **mām**—me; **yaḥ**—who; **abhijānāti**—knows; **karmabhiḥ**—result of action; **na**—never; **saḥ**—that person; **badhyate**—is bound

Actions do not taint Me, nor have I desire for the fruit of actions; He who knows Me thus is not bound by karma.

VERSE 4.15

एवं ज्ञात्वा कृतं कर्म पूर्वैरपि मुमुक्षुभिः ।
कुरु कर्मैव तस्मात्त्वं पूर्वैः पूर्वतरं कृतम् ॥ 15 ॥

evam jñātvā kṛitaṁ karma pūrvair api mumukṣhubhiḥ
kuru karmaiva tasmāttvaṁ pūrvaiḥ pūrvataraṁ kṛitaṁ

evam—thus; **jñātvā**—knowing; **kṛitaṁ**—performed; **karma**—actions; **pūrvaiḥ**—of ancient times; **api**—indeed; **mumukṣhubhiḥ**—seekers of liberation; **kuru**—should perform; **karma**—duty; **eva**—certainly; **tasmāt**—therefore; **tvam**—you; **pūrvaiḥ**—of those ancient sages; **pūrva-taraṁ**—in ancient times; **kṛitaṁ**—performed

Thus knowing, the ancient spiritual aspirants performed the action. Therefore you shall do the same (desireless) action as performed by the ancients in older times.

VERSE 4.16

किं कर्म किमकर्मेति कवयोऽप्यत्र मोहिताः ।
तत्ते कर्म प्रवक्ष्यामि यज्ज्ञात्वा मोक्ष्यसेऽशुभात् ॥ 16 ॥

kim karma kim akarmeti kavayo 'pyatra mohitāḥ
tat te karma pravakṣhyāmi yaj jñātvā mokṣhyase 'śhubhāt

kim—what; **karma**—action; **kim**—what; **akarma**—inaction; **iti**—thus; **kavayaḥ**—the wise; **api**—even; **atra**—in this; **mohitāḥ**—are confused; **tat**—that; **te**—to you; **karma**—action; **pravakṣhyāmi**—I shall explain; **yaj**—which; **jñātvā**—knowing; **mokṣhyase**—you may free yourself; **aśhubhāt**—from inauspiciousness

What is action, and what is not action? In this matter, even the wise are deluded. I will teach you that action knowing which you shall be liberated from evil.

VERSE 4.17

कर्मणो ह्यपि बोद्धव्यं बोद्धव्यं च विकर्मणः ।
अकर्मणश्च बोद्धव्यं गहना कर्मणो गतिः ॥ 17 ॥

karmaṇo hyapi boddhavyaṁ boddhavyaṁ cha vikarmaṇaḥ
akarmaṇaśh cha boddhavyaṁ gahanā karmaṇo gatiḥ

karmaṇaḥ—recommended action; **hi**—certainly; **api**—also; **boddhavyam**—should be known; **boddhavyam**—must understand; **cha**—and; **vikarmaṇaḥ**—forbidden action; **akarmaṇaḥ**—inaction; **cha**—and; **boddhavyam**—must understand; **gahanā**—profound; **karmaṇaḥ**—of action; **gatiḥ**—the true path

The nature of action (enjoined by the Sastras) and of wrong action (prohibited by the Sastras) and also of inaction should be known, because deep and difficult to understand is the path of action.

049. Chapter 4 Verse 18

VERSE 4.18

कर्मण्यकर्म यः पश्येदकर्मणि च कर्म यः ।
स बुद्धिमान्मनुष्येषु स युक्तः कृत्स्नकर्मकृत् ॥ 18 ॥

karmaṇyakarma yaḥ paśhyed akarmaṇi cha karma yaḥ
sa buddhimān manuṣhyeṣhu sa yuktaḥ kṛitsna-karma-kṛit

karmaṇi—action; **akarma**—in inaction; **yaḥ**—who; **paśhyet**—see; **akarmaṇi**—inaction; **cha**—also; **karma**—action; **yaḥ**—who; **saḥ**—they; **buddhi-mān**—wise; **manuṣhyeṣhu**—amongst humans; **saḥ**—they; **yuktaḥ**—yogis; **kṛitsna-karma-kṛit**—performers all kinds of actions

Who sees action in inaction and inaction in action, he is the wise man, the yogi, the doer of all actions among men.

050. Chapter 4 Verse 19

VERSE 4.19

यस्य सर्वे समारम्भाः कामसङ्कल्पवर्जिताः ।
ज्ञानाग्निदग्धकर्माणं तमाहुः पण्डितं बुधाः ॥ 19 ॥

yasya sarve samārambhāḥ kāma-saṅkalpa-varjitāḥ
jñānāgni-dagdha-karmāṇaṁ tam āhuḥ paṇḍitaṁ budhāḥ

yasya—whose; **sarve**—every; **samārambhāḥ**—undertakings; **kāma**—desire for material pleasures; **saṅkalpa**—resolve; **varjitāḥ**—devoid of; **jñāna**—divine knowledge; **agni**—in the fire; **dagdha**—burnt; **karmāṇaṁ**—actions; **tam**—him; **āhuḥ**—address; **paṇḍitaṁ**—a sage; **budhāḥ**—the wise

He whose undertakings are all free from desire and volition, whose actions are burnt in the fire of knowledge, is called a sage by the wise.

051. Chapter 4 Verses 20-22

VERSE 4.20

त्यक्त्वा कर्मफलासङ्गं नित्यतृप्तो निराश्रयः ।
कर्मण्यभिप्रवृत्तोऽपि नैव किञ्चित्करोति सः ॥ 20 ॥

tyaktvā karma-phalāsaṅgaṁ nitya-trīpto nirāśhrayaḥ
karmaṇyabhipravṛitto 'pi naiva kiñchit karoti saḥ

tyaktvā—having given up; **karma-phala-āsaṅgaṁ**—attachment to the fruits of action; **nitya**—always; **trīptaḥ**—satisfied; **nirāśhrayaḥ**—without dependence; **karmaṇi**—in activities; **abhipravṛittaḥ**—engaged; **api**—despite; **na**—not; **eva**—certainly; **kiñchit**—anything; **karoti**—do; **saḥ**—that person

He who has given up attachment to the fruits of work, who is ever content, who does not depend upon anything, though engaged in action does not verily do anything.

VERSE 4.21

निराशीर्यतचित्तात्मा त्यक्तसर्वपरिग्रहः ।
शरीरं केवलं कर्म कुर्वन्नाप्नोति किल्बिषम् ॥ 21 ॥

nirāśhīr yata-chittātmā tyakta-sarva-parigrahaḥ
śhārīram kevalam karma kurvan nāpnoti kilbiṣham

nirāśhīh—free from expectations; **yata**—controlled; **chitta-ātmā**—mind and intellect; **tyakta**—having abandoned; **sarva**—all; **parigrahaḥ**—the sense of ownership; **śhārīram**—bodily; **kevalam**—only; **karma**—actions; **kurvan**—performing; **na**—never; **āpnoti**—incurs; **kilbiṣham**—sin

He who is free from hope, who is self-controlled, who has abandoned all possessions, though working merely with the body, does not incur sin.

VERSE 4.22

यदृच्छालाभसन्तुष्टो द्वन्द्वातीतो विमत्सरः ।
समः सिद्धावसिद्धौ च कृत्वापि न निबध्यते ॥ 22 ॥

yadṛichchhā-lābha-santuṣṭho dvandvātīto vimatsaraḥ
samaḥ siddhāvasiddhau cha kṛitvāpi na nibadhyate

yadṛichchhā—which comes of its own accord; lābha—gain; santuṣṭaḥ—contented; dvandva—duality; atītaḥ—surpassed; vimatsaraḥ—free from envy; samaḥ—equipoised; siddhau—in success; asiddhau—failure; cha—and; kṛitvā—performing; api—even; na—never; nibadhyate—is bound

Content with whatsoever he gets without efforts, free from the pairs of opposites, free from malice, balanced in success and failure, though acting, he is not bound.

052. Chapter 4 Verses 23-24

VERSE 4.23

गतसङ्गस्य मुक्तस्य ज्ञानावस्थितचेतसः ।
यज्ञायाचरतः कर्म समग्रं प्रविलीयते ॥ 23 ॥

gata-saṅgasya muktasya jñānāvasthita-chetasah
yajñāyācharataḥ karma samagraṁ praviliyate

gata-saṅgasya—free from material attachments; **muktasya**—of the liberated;
jñāna-avasthita—established in divine knowledge; **chetasaḥ**—whose intellect;
yajñāya—as a sacrifice (to God); **ācharataḥ**—performing; **karma**—action;
samagram—completely; **praviliyate**—are free

**Of the man who is devoid of attachment, who is liberated,
whose mind is established in knowledge, the whole action
performed in the spirit of sacrifice is dissolved.**

VERSE 4.24

ब्रह्मार्पणं ब्रह्म हविर्ब्रह्माग्नौ ब्रह्मणा हुतम् ।
ब्रह्मैव तेन गन्तव्यं ब्रह्मकर्मसमाधिना ॥ 24 ॥

brahmārpaṇam brahma havir brahmāgnau brahmaṇā hutam
brahmaiva tena gantavyam brahma-karma-samādhinā

brahma—Brahman; **arpaṇam**—the ladle and other offerings; **brahma**—Brahman; **haviḥ**—the oblation; **brahma**—Brahman; **agnau**—in the sacrificial fire; **brahmaṇā**—by that person; **hutam**—offered; **brahma**—Brahman; **eva**—certainly; **tena**—by that; **gantavyam**—to be attained; **brahma**—Brahman; **karma**—offering; **samādhinā**—those completely absorbed in God-consciousness

The oblation is Brahman, the offerings are Brahman, the sacrifice is Brahman, and by absorption in action which is Brahman, Brahman alone shall be reached by him (by the sacrifice).

053. Chapter 4 Verses 25-28

VERSE 4.25

दैवमेवापरे यज्ञं योगिनः पर्युपासते ।
ब्रह्माग्नावपरे यज्ञं यज्ञेनैवोपजुह्वति ॥ 25 ॥

daivam evāpare yajñam yoginaḥ paryupāsate
brahmāgnāvapare yajñam yajñenaivopajuhvati

daivam—the celestial gods; **eva**—indeed; **apare**—others; **yajñam**—sacrifice; **yoginaḥ**—spiritual practitioners; **paryupāsate**—worship; **brahma**—of the Supreme Truth; **agnau**—in the fire; **apare**—others; **yajñam**—sacrifice; **yajñena**—by sacrifice; **eva**—indeed; **upajuhvati**—offer

Some yogis perform sacrifice pertaining to the Gods only, others by the union of the self (jiva) with Brahman, offer the Jiva as sacrifice in the fire of Brahman.

श्रोत्रादीनीन्द्रियाण्यन्ये संयमाग्निषु जुह्वति ।
शब्दादीन्विषयानन्य इन्द्रियाग्निषु जुह्वति ॥ 26 ॥

śhrotrādīnīndriyāṇyanye sanyamāgniṣhu juhvati
śhabdādīn viṣhayānanya indriyāgniṣhu juhvati

śhrotra-ādīni—such as the hearing process; **indriyāṇi**—senses; **anye**—others; **sanyama**—restraint; **agniṣhu**—in the sacrificial fire; **juhvati**—sacrifice; **śhabda-ādīn**—sound vibration, etc; **viṣhayān**—objects of sense-gratification; **anye**—others; **indriya**—of the senses; **agniṣhu**—in the fire; **juhvati**—sacrifice

Others sacrifice the senses like the organ of hearing etc., in the fires of sense – restraint, and some others sacrifice the sense-objects like sound etc., in the fire of the senses.

VERSE 4.27

सर्वाणीन्द्रियकर्माणि प्राणकर्माणि चापरे ।
आत्मसंयमयोगाग्नौ जुह्वति ज्ञानदीपिते ॥ 27 ॥

sarvāṇīndriya-karmāṇi prāṇa-karmāṇi chāpare
ātma-sanyama-yogāgnau juhvati jñāna-dīpīte

sarvāṇi—all; **indriya**—the senses; **karmāṇi**—functions; **prāṇa-karmāṇi**—functions of the life breath; **cha**—and; **apare**—others; **ātma-sanyama yogāgnau**—in the fire of the controlled mind; **juhvati**—sacrifice; **jñāna-dīpīte**—kindled by knowledge

Others sacrifice all the functions of the senses and the functions of the vital energy (prana) in the fire of the yoga of self-control, illumined by Knowledge.

VERSE 4.28

द्रव्ययज्ञास्तपोयज्ञा योगयज्ञास्तथापरे ।

स्वाध्यायज्ञानयज्ञाश्च यतयः संशितव्रताः ॥ 28 ॥

dravya-yajñās tapo-yajñā yoga-yajñās tathāpare

swādhyāya-jñāna-yajñāśh cha yatayaḥ sanśhita-vratāḥ

dravya-yajñāḥ—offering one’s own wealth as sacrifice; **tapah-yajñāḥ**—offering severe austerities as sacrifice; **yoga-yajñāḥ**—performance of eight-fold path of yogic practices as sacrifice; **tathā**—thus; **apare**—others; **swādhyāya**—cultivating knowledge by studying the scriptures; **jñāna-yajñāḥ**—those offer cultivation of transcendental knowledge as sacrifice; **cha**—also; **yatayaḥ**—these ascetics; **sanśhita-vratāḥ**—observing strict vows

Others offer wealth, austerity and Yoga as sacrifice and again others, the ascetics of rigid vows offer study and knowledge as sacrifice.

054. Chapter 4 Verses 29-30

VERSE 4.29

अपाने जुह्वति प्राणं प्राणेऽपानं तथापरे ।
प्राणापानगती रुद्ध्वा प्राणायामपरायणाः ॥ 29 ॥

apāne juhvati prāṇam prāṇe 'pānam tathāpare
prāṇāpāna-gatī ruddhvā prāṇāyāma-parāyaṇāḥ

apāne—the incoming breath; **juhvati**—offer; **prāṇam**—the outgoing breath; **prāṇe**—in the outgoing breath; **apānam**—incoming breath; **tathā**—also; **apare**—others; **prāṇa**—of the outgoing breath; **apāna**—and the incoming breath; **gatī**—movement; **ruddhvā**—blocking; **prāṇa-āyāma**—control of breath; **parāyaṇāḥ**—wholly devoted;

Some, again, constantly practising the regulation of prāna, offer the oblation of prāna into apāna, and apāna into prāna, or stop the passage of both prāna and apāna. Yet others, restricting their food, offer their prānas in the prānas.

VERSE 4.30

अपरे नियताहाराः प्राणान्प्राणेषु जुह्वति ।
सर्वेऽप्येते यज्ञविदो यज्ञक्षपितकल्मषाः ॥ 30 ॥

apare niyatāhārāḥ prāṇān prāṇeṣhu juhvati
sarve 'pyete yajña-vido yajña-kṣhapita-kalmaṣhāḥ

apare—others; niyata—having controlled; āhārāḥ—food intake; prāṇān—life-breaths; prāṇeṣhu—life-energy; juhvati—sacrifice; sarve—all; api—also; ete—these; yajña-vidāḥ—knowers of sacrifices; yajña-kṣhapita—being cleansed by performances of sacrifices; kalmaṣhāḥ—of impurities

**Others of regulated food, sacrifice the life – breaths in the
life – breaths; all these also are are knowers of sacrifice
whose sins are destroyed by sacrifice.**

055. Chapter 4 Verses 31-32

VERSE 4.31

यज्ञशिष्टामृतभुजो यान्ति ब्रह्म सनातनम् ।
नायं लोकोऽस्त्ययज्ञस्य कुतोऽन्यः कुरुसत्तम ॥ 31 ॥

yajña-śhiṣṭāmṛita-bhujo yānti brahma sanātanam
nāyam loko 'styayajñasya kuto 'nyaḥ kuru-sattama

yajña-śhiṣṭa amṛita-bhujah—they partake of the nectarean remnants of sacrifice; **yānti**—go; **brahma**—the Absolute Truth; **sanātanam**—eternal; **na**—never; **ayam**—this; **lokaḥ**—planet; **asti**—is; **ayajñasya**—for one who performs no sacrifice; **kutaḥ**—how; **anyaḥ**—other (world); **kuru-sat-tama**—best of the Kurus, Arjun

Those who eat the remnants of sacrifice which is nectar, go to eternal Brahman; to the non- sacrificer, even this world is not, how then can he get a higher world?

VERSE 4.32

एवं बहुविधा यज्ञा वितता ब्रह्मणो मुखे ।
कर्मजान्विद्धि तान्सर्वानिवं ज्ञात्वा विमोक्ष्यसे ॥ 32 ॥

evam bahu-vidhā yajñā vitatā brahmaṇo mukhe
karma-jān viddhi tān sarvān evam jñātvā vimokṣhyase

evam—thus; **bahu-vidhāḥ**—various kinds of; **yajñāḥ**—sacrifices; **vitatāḥ**—have been described; **brahmaṇaḥ**—of the Vedas; **mukhe**—through the mouth; **karma-jān**—originating from works; **viddhi**—know; **tān**—them; **sarvān**—all; **evam**—thus; **jñātvā**—having known; **vimokṣhyase**—you shall be liberated

**Thus various forms of sacrifice are spread out in the Vedas;
know them all to be born of action; thus knowing you shall
be liberated.**

056. Chapter 4 Verses 33-34

VERSE 4.33

श्रेयान्द्रव्यमयाद्यज्ञाज्ज्ञानयज्ञः परन्तप ।
सर्वं कर्माखिलं पार्थ ज्ञाने परिसमाप्यते ॥ 33 ॥

śhreyān dravya-mayād yajñāj jñāna-yajñaḥ parantapa
sarvaṁ karmākhilam pārtha jñāne parisamāpyate

śhreyān—superior; **dravya-mayāt**—of material possessions; **yajñāt**—than the sacrifice; **jñāna-yajñaḥ**—sacrifice performed in knowledge; **parantapa**—subduer of enemies, Arjun; **sarvam**—all; **karma**—works; **akhilam**—all; **pārtha**—Arjun, the son of Pritha; **jñāne**—in knowledge; **parisamāpyate**—culminate

O scorcher of foes! Knowledge-sacrifice is superior to sacrifice performed with objects. All actions, O Arjuna, in their entirety, culminate in Knowledge.

VERSE 4.34

तद्विद्धि प्रणिपातेन परिप्रश्नेन सेवया ।
उपदेक्ष्यन्ति ते ज्ञानं ज्ञानिनस्तत्त्वदर्शिनः ॥ 34 ॥

tad viddhi praṇipātena paripraśhnena sevayā
upadekṣhyanti te jñānam jñāninas tattva-darśhinaḥ

tat—the truth; **viddhi**—try to learn; **praṇipātena**—by approaching a spiritual master; **paripraśhnena**—by humble inquiries; **sevayā**—by rendering service; **upadekṣhyanti**—can impart; **te**—unto you; **jñānam**—knowledge; **jñāninaḥ**—the enlightened; **tattva-darśhinaḥ**—those who have realized the truth

Know that (Knowledge) by long prostration, question, and service (to the master). The sages who have realised the truth will instruct you in that knowledge.

057. Chapter 4 Verses 35-37

VERSE 4.35

यज्ज्ञात्वा न पुनर्मोहमेवं यास्यसि पाण्डव ।
येन भूतान्यशेषेण द्रक्ष्यस्यात्मन्यथो मयि ॥ 35 ॥

yaj jñātvā na punar moham evaṁ yāsyasi pāṇḍava
yena bhūtānyaśheṣheṇa drakṣhyasyātmanyatho mayi

yat—which; **jñātvā**—having known; **na**—never; **punaḥ**—again; **moham**—delusion; **evam**—like this; **yāsyasi**—you shall get; **pāṇḍava**—Arjun, the son of Pandu; **yena**—by this; **bhūtāni**—living beings; **aśheṣhāṇi**—all; **drakṣhyasi**—you will see; **ātmani**—within me (Shree Krishna); **atho**—that is to say; **mayi**—in me

O Arjuna! Having obtained this knowledge, you will not thus be deluded again and by this Knowledge, you will see all beings in your Self and also in Me.

VERSE 4.36

अपि चेदसि पापेभ्यः सर्वेभ्यः पापकृत्तमः ।
सर्वं ज्ञानप्लवेनैव वृजिनं सन्तरिष्यसि ॥ 36 ॥

api ched asi pāpebhyaḥ sarvebhyaḥ pāpa-kṛit-tamaḥ
sarvaṁ jñāna-plavenaiva vṛjinaṁ santariṣhyasi

api—even; **chet**—if; **asi**—you are; **pāpebhyaḥ**—sinners; **sarvebhyaḥ**—of all; **pāpa-kṛit-tamaḥ**—most sinful; **sarvam**—all; **jñāna-plavena**—by the boat of divine knowledge; **eva**—certainly; **vṛjinaṁ**—sin; **santariṣhyasi**—you shall cross over

Even if you are the most sinful of all sinners you shall cross all sin by the raft of Knowledge.

VERSE 4.37

यथैधांसि समिद्धो ऽग्निर्भस्मसात्कुरुते ऽर्जुन ।
ज्ञानाग्निः सर्वकर्माणि भस्मसात्कुरुते तथा ॥ ३७ ॥

yathaidhānsi samiddho 'gnir bhasma-sāt kurute 'rjuna
jñānāgniḥ sarva-karmāṇi bhasma-sāt kurute tathā

yathā—as; **edhānsi**—firewood; **samiddhaḥ**—blazing; **agniḥ**—fire; **bhasma-sāt**—to ashes; **kurute**—turns; **arjuna**—Arjun; **jñāna-agniḥ**—the fire of knowledge; **sarva-karmāṇi**—all reactions from material activities; **bhasma-sāt**—to ashes; **kurute**—it turns; **tathā**—similarly

O Arjuna! Just as blazing fire reduces wood to ashes, even so, the fire of, Knowledge destroys all actions.

058. Chapter 4 Verses 38-41

VERSE 4.38

न हि ज्ञानेन सदृशं पवित्रमिह विद्यते ।
तत्स्वयं योगसंसिद्धः कालेनात्मनि विन्दति ॥ 38 ॥

na hi jñānena sadṛśhaṁ pavitramiha vidyate
tatsvayaṁ yogasansiddhaḥ kālenātmani vindati

na—not; **hi**—certainly; **jñānena**—with divine knowledge; **sadṛśhaṁ**—like; **pavitrām**—pure; **iha**—in this world; **vidyate**—exists; **tat**—that; **svayam**—oneself; **yoga**—practice of yog; **sansiddhaḥ**—he who has attained perfection; **kālena**—in course of time; **ātmani**—within the heart; **vindati**—finds

**Indeed there is nothing so pure as Knowledge in this world.
He who is perfected in Nishkama Karma finds that wisdom
by himself in Atma in due season.**

VERSE 4.39

श्रद्धावान् लभते ज्ञानं तत्परः संयतेन्द्रियः ।
ज्ञानं लब्ध्वा परां शान्तिमचिरेणाधिगच्छति ॥ 39 ॥

śhraddhāvānllabhate jñānam tat-parah sanyatendriyah
jñānam labdhvā parām śhāntim achireṇādhigachchhati

śhraddhāvān—a faithful person; **labhate**—achieves; **jñānam**—divine knowledge; **tat-parah**—devoted (to that); **sanyata**—controlled; **indriyah**—senses; **jñānam**—transcendental knowledge; **labdhvā**—having achieved; **parām**—supreme; **śhāntim**—peace; **achireṇa**—without delay; **adhigachchhati**—attains

**The man of faith, having Knowledge as his supreme goal
having controlled the senses, obtains knowledge of Atma,
and having obtained that enjoys everlasting peace.**

VERSE 4.40

अज्ञश्चाश्रद्धानश्च संशयात्मा विनश्यति ।

नायं लोकोऽस्ति न परो न सुखं संशयात्मनः ॥ 40 ॥

ajñāśh chāśhraddadhānaśh cha sanśhayātmā vinaśhyati

nāyam loko 'sti na paro na sukham sanśhayātmanah

ajñāḥ—the ignorant; **cha**—and; **aśhraddadhānaḥ**—without faith; **cha**—and; **sanśhaya**—skeptical; **ātmā**—a person; **vinaśhyati**—falls down; **na**—never; **ayam**—in this; **lokaḥ**—world; **asti**—is; **na**—not; **paraḥ**—in the next; **na**—not; **sukham**—happiness; **sanśhaya-ātmanah**—for the skeptical soul

But the ignorant man, the faithless man, the doubting man goes to destruction. For the doubting self, there is no happiness either in this world or the next.

VERSE 4.41

योगसंन्यस्तकर्माणं ज्ञानसञ्छिन्नसंशयम् ।
आत्मवन्तं न कर्माणि निबध्नन्ति धनञ्जय ॥ 41 ॥

yoga-sannyasta-karmāṇaṁ jñāna-sañchhinna-sanśhayam
ātmavantam na karmāṇi nibadhnanti dhanañjaya

yoga-sannyasta-karmāṇam—those who renounce ritualistic karm, dedicating their body, mind, and soul to God; **jñāna**—by knowledge; **sañchhinna**—dispelled; **sanśhayam**—doubts; **ātma-vantam**—situated in knowledge of the self; **na**—not; **karmāṇi**—actions; **nibadhnanti**—bind; **dhanañjaya**—Arjun, the conqueror of wealth

O Arjuna! Actions do not bind the man who has surrendered the fruits of karma by yoga, whose doubts are cleared by Knowledge, and who is firmly established in the Self.

059. Chapter 4 Verse 42 + Ch 4 Summary

VERSE 4.42

तस्मादज्ञानसम्भूतं हृत्स्थं ज्ञानासिनात्मनः ।
छित्त्वैनं संशयं योगमातिष्ठोत्तिष्ठ भारत ॥ 42 ॥

tasmād ajñāna-sambhūtaṁ hṛit-sthaṁ jñānāsinātmanaḥ
chhittvainaṁ sanśhayaṁ yogam ātiṣṭhotttiṣṭha bhārata

tasmāt—therefore; **ajñāna-sambhūtaṁ**—born of ignorance; **hṛit-sthaṁ**—situated in the heart; **jñāna**—of knowledge; **asinā**—with the sword; **ātmanaḥ**—of the self; **chhittvā**—cut asunder; **enam**—this; **sanśhayaṁ**—doubt; **yogam**—in karm yog; **ātiṣṭha**—take shelter; **uttiṣṭha**—arise; **bhārata**—Arjun, descendant of Bharat

Therefore, with the sword of Knowledge cut asunder the doubt born of ignorance about the Self, dwelling in the heart and take refuge in Yoga. Arise, O Arjuna!